Project B: Dear future...

Presentation: Due August 8, 2024
Documentation: Due August 9, 2024

Introduction:

(find detailed *description and instructions on page3)*

...after returning from this year's Generative Biodiversity Congress where your recent discovery has been lauded by the international scientific community, you find yourself once again under the fluorescent lights of the IMA studio hunching over your laptop. The screen displays intricate coding as you tinker with your latest project—**a revolutionary internet portal capable of sending a website one thousand years into the future**.

"It's done," you whisper triumphantly, your fingers trembling over the 'Activate' button.

Without hesitation, you press it. The laptop whirs to life, emitting a faint hum as the portal shimmes into existence. The studio quivers with energy, and a low, pulsating sound fills the air.

"Wow, it's actually working!" you say in disbelief, your voice tingling with excitement.

As you **select the website you made for Project B to send through the portal**, a sudden scream echoed through the IMA studio. Startled, you turned to see a 保安 Security Guard standing at the entrance, his eyes wide with shock.

"What did you do?" he shouts in Chinese, his voice laced with fear.

Before you can respond, the portal flickers and vanishes, leaving nothing but a lingering sense of unease in the air.

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Throughout history, civilizations as well as individuals, have received or found **messages from the past**.

Cueva de las Manos (Spanish for "Cave of the Hands") is a cave located in the province of Santa Cruz, Argentina [...] The negative hand impressions date to around 550 BC, the positive impressions from 180 BC, while the hunting drawings are calculated to more than 10,000 years old. (Wikipedia)

Fisherman Konrad Fischer (shown in image) found the bottle 101 years after Richard Platz tossed it into the Baltic while on a hike on the German coast. Though Platz died in 1946, a genealogist followed the clues and found his way to the door of his granddaughter, Angela Erdmann. (source)
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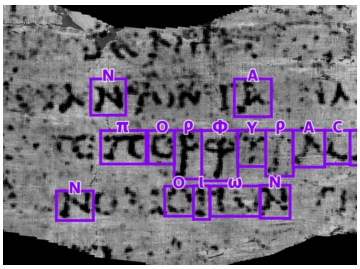
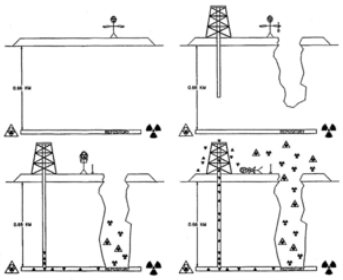
Three students have won a $700,000 prize after using AI to read a 2,000-year-old scroll burnt during the Mount Vesuvius eruption in 79AD. [...] It is thought to have belonged to Julius Caesar's father-in-law and talks of music and food. (BCC article)



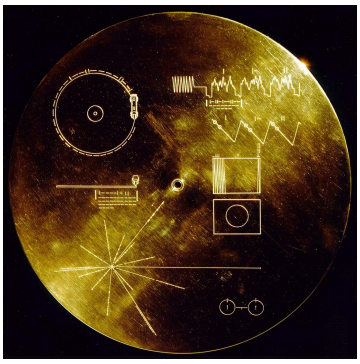
At the same time, there are ongoing attempts to **communicate with others in the distant future or a distant place.**



Nuclear semiotics is an interdisciplinary field of research [...]
It asks: "How would it be possible to inform our descendants for the next 10,000 years about the storage locations and dangers of radioactive waste?"

French author Françoise Bastide and the Italian semiotician Paolo Fabbri proposed the breeding of so-called "radiation cats" or "ray cats". [...] These radiation cats would change significantly in color when they came near radioactive emissions and serve as living indicators of danger. (Wikipedia)

During the latter part of his life, Warhol created over 600 Time Capsules [...] Warhol would simply fill a cardboard box with a variety of objects that represented a period of time. Each Time Capsule became an archival treasure trove, teaching us about the life, art, and career of Andy Warhol. The items contained in his Time Capsules range from everyday ephemera to valuable artworks and everything in between (including autographed underwear)! (source and more info)



"Hello from the children of Planet Earth"
The Voyager Golden Records [...] were included aboard the two Voyager spacecraft launched in 1977. The records contain sounds and images selected to portray the diversity of life and culture on Earth, and are intended for any intelligent extraterrestrial life form who may find them. The records are a time capsule. (you can hear some of the sounds on the Wikipedia)

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Description:

Data on the internet has a very long lifetime, and web pages remain like time capsules. We can still find sites from the early days of the web (ref1, ref2), and **content we create today might be found far in the future.** What we publish can **be encountered by a wide audience from around the world and maybe beyond!**

For this project, you are asked to build a website for this audience, many years and/or far away: **What message will you send through the *internet portal*?**

Questions for your Ideation Process:

In your creative process you have to think about key questions:

- What do you want to communicate on this page, and why? What message will be *worth* for future viewers to uncover?
- Who do you address? Is this page for an individual (a *pen-pal*) or a group?
- How will the viewer be able to interact and understand your page? Will whoever sees this have the same biological conditions as we do? Or not be human altogether? (ref1, ref2)
- How will your page be rendered then? Will the future viewer see them on an ordinary rectangular landscape display?

~ Find more tips on how to get started on page 5

Extended Description:

In the previous projects and recitations, you created interactive drawings, experimented with generative motion, designed patterns, and more. The prompts largely revolved around the specific technical concepts you were introduced to at the time.

Project B expands this focus, allowing you to explore your new skills as a grammar to treat a **subject you have personal connection to**, or interest in. Consider what information you want to deliver and how; for example, can one engage best with your subject if you include playful interactions? interactive story-telling? or is this a type of experimental new language with sound and/or visuals?

Consider the **technical competencies** you have developed in this course, and the creative ways we can use code, web elements, the browser and computer. Try to incorporate different things you have learned this semester and explore how they can be **combined in a meaningful way**.

Next Sessions (and what you will still learn):

In the remaining session, we will build upon our previous learnings: you will get to know Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) to structure your code, and be introduced to advanced techniques for your project including creating layouts in CSS. You may also include sound and images. Optional Expanded Lectures (videos) dive deeper into CSS and pixel-based projects respectively.

Requirements:

Your project should be accessible to the public on **a website hosted on GitHub (introduced in Week 3)**. The website should **include at a minimum** two **HTML** pages, **CSS**, and a canvas that is controlled by **p5.js**. The central part of your p5 code should be at least one class (**OOP**).

📚 **Project Proposal.** Due July 30, 2024 (detailed prompt)
This will be delivered in the form of a short Google Slide deck.
✨ **Project Presentation.** Due August 8, 2024
Your project must be finished. People without your instruction or supervision should be able to successfully engage with it.
📝 **Project Documentation.** Due August 9, 2024 (detailed prompt)
The documentation includes two components: one to introduce your project to a public audience and another one for you to reflect on your process and the outcome.

Reminder from CCLAb's syllabus:

It is important that your code is written by yourself and only uses the concepts that are part of CCLab's course materials (e.g. you shouldn't use vectors in your code since they were not covered). You should not use ChatGPT or other AI tools for any purpose other than idea generation. When you use any of these tools, you must include a note describing how you used them with the assignment; please also reflect on your experience with these tools.

Please also review the CCLab Academic Honesty Statement.

Additional Tips

* Where to start?

The best topic is one that you have genuine **interest** in and **enjoy** thinking about. Consider also the following:

- If you see a **connection** between the topic and some of the various forms and techniques we have encountered in this course, that would be a good starting point.
- Can you think of aspects of this topic that are well-suited to be **translated into code**?
- Also, consider the technical difficulty that realizing your idea would require, and whether you feel comfortable with it?
- Optional: The Expanded Lecture Videos may help you decide on the scope of your project and how to approach the technical development of your idea.

* How to develop your idea?

Imagine you sit in the studio working on your project. Someone walks by and, seeing how focused you seem on your work, asks you "What are you working on?".
This is about the answer to this question. Try to express in a few words, what your project attempts to be? Here are some points to consider:

- Is the form you pick within the possibilities of the techniques learned in this class and seems realistic given your skill level?
- Have you seen other projects of the same kind that you particularly like and can get **inspiration** from? This, too, will be part of your Project Proposal.
- Visitors of your page should be able to interact with your project without your instruction or supervision.

Inspiration / Possible forms:

Story Game **Interactive journalism or documentary** **Pixel manipulation**
A tool **A simulation** **Generative visuals**
Interactive audio visualization **Story** **Interactive visualization**
Text generation **Generative sound**

* Where to go from there?

Your first idea might not be the one with the most potential. Explain your idea to your friends, fellows and instructors and hear their feedback. A crucial consideration is whether subject, form and your ability to realize it can come together. Is this idea achievable with the techniques learnt in class? Or would it require learning a whole new technology or language?

Once settled, consider the following timeline and don't forget to document your process well (screenshots, notes, work-in-progress copies of your code).

Week 4.1: Project Brief (Thu)

<u>You should be here:</u> This week, you need to identify the topic & form of your project and draft the proposal. Ask

your peers for feedback. Arrange a meeting with your instructor to talk through your ideas.

Week 4.2 and Week 5

Key-Learning for the Project: Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)

Week 5 (Mon 7 Tue): Individual Meetings with your Instructor

Please come prepared with an idea and an effective way to communicate this idea (visuals!). An initial prototype would be ideal.

Week 5.1: Proposal is due (Tue)

You should be here: This week, your project should begin to take form. The most tricky parts are yet to be resolved, but this week is a good time to build out the foundation of it.

Week 6.1: Interaction Day (Tue)

You should be here: The focus is now exclusively on the code. Tackle the most intricate parts and make your friends test, test, test your project. On Interaction day, your project should be nearly complete.

Week 6.2: Presentations 🥂